

INDIA TODAY ARCHIVE

1987

Under **Farooq Abdullah** and **Rajiv Gandhi**, the NC and Congress form an electoral alliance, while Islamists come together under the banner of the Muslim United Front. The NC-Congress alliance wins, but there are widespread allegations that the election was rigged

1986

Shah courts Islamists by announcing the construction of a mosque within the secretariat premises, next to a Hindu shrine in Jammu. Communal tensions worsen after the Babri Masjid in Uttar Pradesh is opened to Hindu pilgrims. Protests turn into riots across Kashmir, its worst till then; the army is called in. The Centre dismisses the state administration and imposes Governor's Rule under **Jagmohan** (appointed in 1984)



1988

Buoyed by its success in deploying jihadists against Soviet forces in Afghanistan, the ISI looks to replicate the strategy in Kashmir, funneling arms and training to militants in India. Insurgents step up violence in the Valley, with the JKLF's Indian wing rising in prominence. Four men—Hamid Sheikh, Ashfaq Wani, Javed Ahmad Mir and **Yasin Malik**—form the core group



SHARAD SAXENA

1989

Congress defeat in the national election brings in the V.P. Singh coalition government; Kashmiri leader **Mufti Mohammad Sayeed** is made Union home minister. Insurgents carry out a series of attacks in J&K, including the murder of NC activist Mohammad Yusuf Halwai, BJP member Tika Lal Taploo and judge **Neelkanth Ganjoo**, who had sentenced Maqbool Bhat to death. In December, Sayeed's daughter **Rubaiya** is kidnapped by JKLF militants. Negotiations result in her being freed in exchange for the release of five captured militants



1990-91

As the violence and threats intensify and after several shocking murders, including the killing of four air force personnel and many Kashmiri Pandits, a massive exodus begins. Some estimate that over 90 per cent of the community flees the Valley in this period. By 1991, an estimated 689 Pandits have been killed, with about 77,000 fleeing to neighbouring Jammu

1990

With the law-and-order situation deteriorating, PM V.P. Singh re-appoints Jagmohan as Governor on January 19; CM Farooq Abdullah resigns in protest. A crackdown is ordered on militants with house-to-house searches, sparking protests. On January 21, security forces open fire on protesters in Srinagar, leaving 50 people dead in the Gawkadal massacre. Insurgency rocks the Valley, with security personnel and Kashmiri Pandits being targeted. Threatening messages are broadcast from mosques and in newspapers, warning Pandits to leave and demanding that Kashmiris observe Islamic dress codes



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